

Step 6: Push to GitHub

Back up your project to your own private GitHub repository.

This step commits and pushes your project (notebooks, code, small output files) to a private GitHub repository, creating it automatically the first time if it doesn't exist. It never pushes the `downloads/` folder — a text file listing every downloaded file's name and size is committed instead, so there's a record without the multi-gigabyte data.

You need a Personal Access Token, not your password

GitHub removed password-based Git access in 2021. You need a Personal Access Token (PAT) instead:

- 1 Go to `github.com/settings/tokens` while signed in to your own GitHub account.
- 2 Click **Generate new token** → **classic**.
- 3 Give it any name, set an expiration you're comfortable with, and check the **repo** scope box.
- 4 Click Generate, then copy the token immediately — GitHub only shows it once.
- 5 Paste it into the token field when prompted. It's held only in memory for that run, never written to disk.

If you get a 401 Unauthorized error

This means GitHub rejected the token itself — not a permissions problem. Common causes:

- The token expired or was revoked — generate a new one.
- A stray space or newline got pasted along with it — re-paste carefully.
- You entered your GitHub account password by mistake instead of a token — passwords no longer work here at all.

■ **Tip** — Re-running the whole flow after fixing the token is always safe — it only creates the repo once and only commits when something actually changed.